

My newest employee shipped in one day.

Meet Harold: an autonomous publisher for Good News Network's Instagram. It picks the story, designs the card, writes the caption, and posts — four times a day, without me.

SUBJECT An AI employee	METHOD Direct → approve → run	BY Joe Quattrone
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I didn't prompt an app into existence. I directed one.

I wrote no code and opened no design tool. My contribution was decisions: what it makes, how it looks, when it's allowed to act. The AI handled everything between my decisions.

First commit to live post: 13 hours, 20 minutes.

- 6:57 pm — first commit.
- 7:13 pm — signature card design approved, then locked.
- overnight — scheduled in the cloud. No machine of mine runs it.
- 8:16 am — first live post on @goodnewsnetwork (48.8K followers).

24 pull requests merged in the first ~24 hours.

03 THE GRIND

The messy middle **is the actual work.**

Five separate fixes just to get one API's tokens working — invisible characters, undocumented formats, the works. The AI hit every error, diagnosed it, and shipped the repair. I never opened the docs.

5 PRS OF TOKEN PLUMBING

the part every AI-hype post leaves out

04 THE TASTE LOOP

Some hours, my whole job was “the badge is too big.”

Five rounds of design notes, six pixels at a time. The AI was the hands. I was the eyes.

● posted live, day one		12
● earned their spot		6
● pulled by the editor (me)		6

taste is still the human's job. that's the point.

A demo works when you watch it. An employee works when you don't.

- Dry-run by default — nothing posts without an approved preview.
- Quality gate — a bad photo can't ship an ugly card at 2 a.m.
- Ledger — it remembers every post. It never repeats itself.

autonomy is granted, never assumed.

Platforms don't pay in money. They pay in **distribution.**

To get what you want — reach and engagement — you give the platform what it wants: supply. Instagram can't keep users fed by bottlenecking creation on its own taste. It has to incentivize makers, and reach is the paycheck.

Harold never misses a payday.

07 THE MATH PEOPLE SKIP

Payroll: $\approx$ \$0 a month.

Four posts a day, on schedule, unattended, on free-tier infrastructure. My total investment: one day of direction and a few minutes of taste. The output compounds daily.

Headcount scales linearly.
Systems compound.

Now I'm turning it on myself.

I've already written the book. The machine does the rest:

- An agent serializes the book into Substack articles.
- Harold transcreates each one for Instagram and Facebook.
- One source. Every platform. On schedule.

same pattern: direct → approve → run.

The human is the hero. AI is the companion.

I decide what the brand says, how it looks, and what it's allowed to do alone. The system handles everything in between. That's building on my terms.

Signed by:



Envelope ID: HAROLD-BUILD-2C4F-0716

See the build live: @goodnewsnetwork on Instagram • follow for more field notes on the Human OS.